

Ecosystems

Plants and animals live and interact with each other and their surroundings in communities called ecosystems. Ecosystems can be as small as a tree trunk or as large as a rainforest.

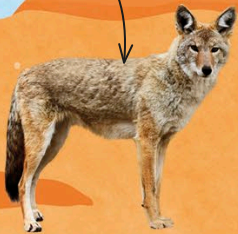


The biggest coral reef is the Great Barrier Reef off the coast of eastern Australia.

American desert

The deserts of southwest USA are extremely hot but lots of animals and plants live there. Animals avoid the heat of the day by hunting at night, and plants can survive a long time without any rain.

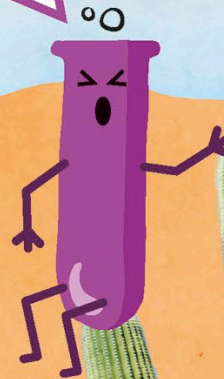
Coyotes survive in many different places because they will eat whatever is available!



The organ pipe cactus opens its flowers at night.



The sharp spines will put off any egg thieves!



The great horned owl makes its nests on saguaro cactuses, where its eggs will be safe from predators.



This rattlesnake will shake the rattle on the end of its tail if it feels threatened.



The saguaro cactus is the largest cactus in the USA.

